

to do is chip in ourselves and stop participating in the never ending upgrade cycle – at least as much as we can help it. So you use a two-year old phone, or maybe even a three year old phone, and buy appropriately. For example, buying a cheap phone every year might work out more expensive in the long run as compared to buying a flagship phone once every three years. So not only will you save money, you will also be buying fewer phones which results in lower e-waste and carbon emissions from mining and the like, and you can also

a new device to play with (which is what happened when the pandemic hit), we start to have withdrawal symptoms that end up causing us to start buying things online just to get a new product to unbox...

While we're pretty sure that people in general are not as bad as us, but there are enough and more people out there who feel the same way every few months, and need something new to play with. What this does is kill off all plans you have towards saving.

Buying gadgets is not the only way your wallet is emptied. Take some-

Gaming is now ubiquitous, and we all have multiple game service accounts... our phones have apps we use that we pay for, especially if you're using iOS... and the costs just keep increasing.

Is this necessarily a bad thing? Not really, but consider that India was the home of piracy just a decade or two ago, and we're still not completely used to paying for digital items like software or services. We will get there and start factoring in all of these costs when we buy devices in the future, but for now it does leave the wallet looking a little undernourished!



Too much choice, better get it all

choose to support a company that has a proper plan to reduce their carbon footprint on the planet. Just something you can consider!

SAVINGS (MONEY)

If there is one thing technology has killed off, it's the concept of saving. In fact, technology is not at all kind to your wallet, which is something all of us geeks can attest to. Heck, so many of us are taking loans in order to buy the best in technology, just to be on the cutting edge, and we can't believe we're saying this out loud, but perhaps it's silly to be that way!

Here at Team Digit we're a bunch of tech-addicted geeks, so we start getting angsty if we don't get our regular gadget fix. By this we mean that we're so used to a new gadget arriving at our test labs every second day, that if we have to go a week or two without

something simple like streaming services. There are so many of them, each with their own programming, all of it that we want to watch. The solution? Pay for all of them. Of course if you're younger you're probably in a group of three or four friends all of whom pay for one service each and share logins with the others so that each one only pays for one service but has access to all. This is technically illegal, of course, and goes against the EULAs of the services, but can you blame college kids for doing it this way to save some money?

Then you add on the cost of software needed for work or studies, any subscriptions to cloud storage or services like Gmail, and of course if you have smart devices that you want to be able to access from anywhere, you might have subscription costs of those services to pay for as well.

HEALTH

WebMD has ruined things for doctors across the globe. Thanks to us being able to put symptoms into an online symptom checker, and then getting a list of diseases we might possibly have, we're all turning into a bunch of hypochondriacs. For every symptom you have, there is some cancer out there that also has the same symptom listed, and of course many of us will jump to the conclusion that we not only have cancer now, but it's in advanced stages, and we start planning our wills. All along, of course, we probably have just a headache, or maybe a bacterial infection, but no one will jump to that conclusion because it's boring.

The result? Doctors have to spend time reassuring you that you do not have pancreatic cancer just because you have lost your appetite for the past 2 days. It's like saying a majority of illnesses present with a symptom of fever, and thus, having a fever could be anything from lack of sleep and exhaustion, to COVID or even HIV, and then you jumping to the conclusion that it is definitely HIV.

Things like COVID do not help the cause of course, because that is a disease caused by a new virus that doctors really were well and truly clueless about, at least in the beginning. So many people would have been told they had the flu, only to later find out they had contracted COVID-19, and this weakens their belief in doctors, and pushes them to look for answers online.